

Code of Conduct

Behaviour and safety expectations for everyone involved with Jackson Hacks.

Version 2026-09-23 | Last updated September 23, 2026

1. Purpose and scope

Jackson Hacks is committed to a welcoming, safe, inclusive, and educational environment. This Code applies to applicants, participants, Organizers, volunteers, mentors, judges, sponsors, guests, and school personnel during the application process, online communications, project work, judging, and all Event spaces.

2. Expected behaviour

- Treat others with respect, patience, and consideration.
- Welcome participants of different backgrounds and experience levels.
- Ask for consent before physical contact or sharing another person's information.
- Give constructive feedback about work rather than attacking a person.
- Follow safety directions, venue rules, and reasonable Organizer instructions.
- Respect personal space, accessibility needs, pronouns, belongings, and boundaries.
- Report safety or conduct concerns promptly and cooperate honestly with investigations.

3. Protected grounds and inclusion

Harassment or discrimination based on age, ancestry, citizenship, colour, creed, disability, ethnic origin, family status, gender expression, gender identity, marital status, place of origin, race, sex, sexual orientation, or any other ground protected by applicable law or school policy is prohibited.

4. Prohibited behaviour

- Harassment, bullying, intimidation, stalking, threats, or unwanted sexual attention.
- Discriminatory comments, slurs, demeaning imagery, deliberate misgendering, or exclusionary conduct.
- Violence, dangerous behaviour, weapons, alcohol, illegal drugs, or encouraging another person to take unreasonable risks.
- Theft, vandalism, tampering with equipment, or deliberate disruption of the Event.
- Plagiarism, misrepresenting project work, manipulating judging, or interfering with another team.
- Publishing another person's private information or recording them outside the authorized Event media process.
- Retaliating against someone who reports a concern or assists an investigation.

5. Digital systems and cybersecurity

Participants may not access accounts, networks, devices, databases, applications, or personal information without explicit authorization. Malware, credential theft, denial-of-service activity, destructive testing, automated account creation, and testing against real users or production systems are prohibited.

A suspected vulnerability must be reported privately to ayjacksonhacks@gmail.com. Good-faith reports do not authorize access to personal information, disruption, or testing outside an expressly approved environment.

6. Project integrity

Projects must be created during the Event by teams of one to four participants. Open-source components and artificial-intelligence tools are allowed when used lawfully and disclosed. Teams must credit meaningful third-party code, assets, datasets, and tools and must not claim another person's work as their own.

7. Reporting

During the Event, concerns may be reported to an Organizer or supervising school staff member. Before or after the Event, reports may be sent to ayjacksonhacks@gmail.com. In an immediate emergency, contact 911 and alert venue staff.

Reports will be handled as privately as reasonably possible, but information may be shared with authorized people when needed to investigate, protect safety, comply with school policy, or meet a legal obligation. Anonymous reports may be considered, although limited information can make investigation difficult.

8. Response and consequences

Depending on seriousness and context, consequences may include a reminder, warning, separation from another person, removal from an activity, restricted system access, project disqualification, removal from the Event, loss of prizes, parent or guardian contact, school discipline referral, or contact with emergency services or law enforcement.

Organizers will prioritize immediate safety and may take temporary protective action before an investigation is complete. When appropriate and safe, the affected person will have an opportunity to provide relevant information.

9. No retaliation

Retaliation against a person for making a good-faith report, requesting help, participating in an investigation, or declining inappropriate conduct is prohibited and may result in separate consequences. Knowingly false or malicious reports may also violate this Code.

10. Questions

Questions about this Code or requests for accessibility or safety arrangements may be sent to ayjacksonhacks@gmail.com.